

Special School Committee Meeting - Notes - June 25, 2020 - 4 PM - via Zoom

Mayor called meeting to order at 4:01 PM

Roll Call - 7-0

Salute the Flag

Mayor - Notifications and facility fees -

Dr. Cushing - We are in the process of putting together a liability waiver, as well as, a cleaning upgrades requirement - we hope to meet with renters shortly and try to get them back in by July 6th. We plan to add an additional - \$100 fee for cleaning requirements- for rental of gym, cafe, theater and an additional \$75 - for rental of classrooms & foyer

Member Van der Kloot - I don't have anything in front of me to compare this too ...

Dr. Cushing - Basically it will be for sanitation, gloves, purell - added to charges - to share with our renters - added charges -already had an extensive conversation with John McLaughlin and he has already ordered additional cleaning supplies - the additional monies will be for John to be able to replenish supplies as needed

Member Graham - July 6th?

Dr. Cushing - Yes. The pool has been contacted by a few groups for rentals, and we have already preliminary conversations with churches and others - checklists for cleaning, and going over the requirements of informing us if one of their attendees were to test positive, having had extensive conversations with Toni Wray and MaryAnn O'Connor

Ms. Perry - If I may, the North Shore Swim Club has reached out to me, as well as, a scuba company, who'd like to conduct a scuba class. Of course following all CDC guidelines

Member Van der Kloot - What about our church groups?

Dr. Cushing - They have reached out to us to re use our facilities at a 40% usage

Ms. Patterson - It's a part of budget binder that we'll review on Monday

Member Ruseau - What is the fee for the Japanese Language School?

Dr. Cushing - We'd like to sit down with them as their use a larger part of the facility

Member Ruseau - I'd like to see if a floor is too high for them, maybe we can work with them, I don't want to lose them

Motion to approve by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call Vote

6 -in the affirmative

1 in the negative

Paper passes

Member Graham - I voted no because I feel we should see the rates. That they should be opaque.

Dr. Edouard Vincent - For your information, there is a formal proposal that must be completed and forwarded to the Board of Health for approval prior to any rentals being considered. Additionally, we will have separate requirements/checklist that they will be required to produce to use our facilities - these are important pieces that can not be overlooked.

Member Graham - I appreciate that but I would like to see it all in writing

Member Van der Kloot - For our new members, be advised that two years ago, we delved into these rates and established new rates, so that work has been done.

Member Graham - It's not on the website

Member McLaughlin - Can the rate card motion be amended to the July meeting?

Member Ruseau - An additional amendment - legacy rates - do away with grandfathering and change to legacy - Does everyone pay these rates? Or does everyone get the legacy rates? If no one has to pay for it then why discuss it? At some point, legacy should be eliminated

Ms Patterson - Please be advised that the rates are on the website - I'll share the link - historical rates have been re negotiated - that work has already been done - the additional part that would have to be added to the website, would be the Board of Health sign off form.

Member Ruseau - Can the word, grandfather, be striked out?

Mayor - Member Graham please send to Ms. Evangelista

On the motion by Member Graham, seconded by Member McLaughlin ... Full rate card for July Meeting as well as a report of renters of the last year, including rental times and rates

Member Van der Kloot - Point of information - without Ms. Patterson, I'm not sure who will provide this? Who will gather that data?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - the original motion would have been fine - the change will be difficult - I can get the original motion, but the second motion we'll need time

Member Van der Kloot - reviewing who's been in is important - we did look at the rates in depth already - could the second piece of motion be put off to later in the fall due to time constraints?

Member Graham - we are in budget crisis & we are not looking at all our revenue sources, but I'll severe motion for the due date

Motion by Member Graham, seconded by Member McLaughlin - to receive a full rate card of our rental fees rental fee schedule in time for the July meeting. Further that all rates will be posted to our website.

Roll Call Vote

7-0 motion passes

Member Graham makes motion, seconded by Member Van der Kloot that the Superintendent will provide a full report of renters for the past school year which includes time duration of rental and rate paid by September 1, 2020.

Roll Call Vote

7-0 - Motion passes

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I just checked the calendar and September 1st is the first day of school. I could have it for you at the first September school committee meeting.

Member Van der Kloot - that's acceptable

Mayor - Notification of Summer Fun Camp

Dr. Vincent - As a result of the pandemic, we regret to announce that the Summer Fun Camp will not operate this year. After meeting with Dr. Cushing, Ms. Wray, Ms. O'Connor, Mr. McLaughlin, Mr. Maloney, Ms. Perry, Camp Director Petrelis with Maryann, John Mac, Joan, Bob Maloney, Rachel Perry, and Director Anthony Petrelis and myself, it was decided that due to: not enough PPE and the limits on group size, we could not effectively guarantee a safe environment. However, our goal is to look forward to continuing it next year in 2021. It will be the Camp's 15th Anniversary.

Member McLaughlin - I echo the Superintendent and thank the feasibility study team - Anthony Petrelis has been a very dedicated and inclusive director. I feel sad that counselors won't be hired for summer jobs as well. I thank everyone for their efforts

Mayor - Thank you everyone. We do not need any motion on this information. It was provided for our official notification. We will now move onto the budget for FY 20 / FY 21- (Supt Budget Update on computer)

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The economic turmoil caused by the 2020 Global Pandemic has been unprecedented and entirely unforeseen. This situation has thrust difficult decisions upon our school district that we would not typically make. The economic impact to the city of Medford requires a level funded budget from the Medford Public Schools which equals 3.5 million in cuts to our current levels of services and staffing. Our budget guiding principles were: Prioritizing the classroom experience for students and eliminating positions farthest away from classrooms as much as possible. Identifying redundancies in the administration's organizational structures and thinking creatively about how to shift responsibilities. Investing, where possible, in critical areas for the district in technology and in instructional areas. While the budget process began in earnest at the start of the calendar year with the goal of providing the students of Medford with the best possible education, the pandemic changed it all. State and local projections for FY21 changed dramatically and remain uncertain to the loss of tax revenues. Therefore, the schools had to cut \$3.5 M in order to be able to present a level funded budget:

Categories Estimated Cost Savings

Position Reduction **\$1,420,000**

Leadership Positions Restructured **\$950,000**

Retirements (with replacements) **\$330,000**

Non-personnel (Supplies and contracted services) **\$800,000**

Estimated Total **\$3,500,000**

Budget Headlines:

- Hiring of additional EL teacher at secondary
- Investments in technology
 - Chromebooks
 - Subscriptions to support

Potential Investments:

- Technology Personnel and Infrastructure
- Staff Professional Development
- Online Literacy Development (Diagnostics and Instruction)
- Social and Emotional Supports

Thank you to all of our faculty, staff, families, caregivers, students, and community members for your support and understanding through this unprecedented economic crisis.

Ms. Patterson - I echo the Superintendent's concerns. These are truly unprecedented times and the effects are much more than the crash of 2008 - We have been working non stop to minimize the cuts - But I wouldn't say it is a level service budget.

MHS - \$894,227

Middle Schools - \$742,748

Elementary - 2nd tier teaching components - going back to classrooms -- \$9M

EL - \$2M

Special Education - very structured - knowing at this point, there could be additional student placement - we have tried to pre pay to offset this area - to utilize state reimbursement for circuit breaker -

Vocational Education - significant reductions - for out of district students - decreased tremendously - \$2M

Guidance - reorganization - \$8,993,00

ELA - books/supplies - \$2M

Social Studies - books/supplies - \$2 M

Math - included the structured programming already from prior year - restructured staffing - \$2M

Science - supporting the FOSS program implementation Year 2 of 3

World Language - did see a reduction with no CASIT - \$1M

Fine Arts - supply savings from FY 20 - \$1M

Phys Ed & Health - restructuring of Staff - kept as many supplies as possible - \$1M

Library, Media & Computers - staffing changes - reduced the need to purchase devices - purchased instead from capital monies and CARES money - \$1M

Health Services - (Nurses) - really couldn't reduce this area with the medical crisis - nursing requirements will be even more stretched - \$1M

Transportation Costs - bid process - slight savings - homeless transp - \$1.5 M

Athletics - based on unknowns for fall season - we will maintain all middle school sports but will consolidate freshmen sports into JV and Varsity - fall coaches will likely be less - \$597,000

Student Activities - stipends & supplies - may not be as active - no reductions

Security - door monitors at all buildings, reduced supplies - \$341,000

Operations, carpentry, Maintenance - supplies & contracted services had to be reduced a bit - purchasing ahead of time - \$5M

Supplement the \$99,675,000 - looking at revenue for upcoming year - when or how much the outside renters will be willing to participate - so as not to go any deeper - we don't want the district to get to a point that it can't operate-

Member Van der Kloot - Can you please repeat the athletics line

Ms Patterson - in light of not knowing what the MIAA would be allowing, we thought it would be prudent to maintain the middle school athletics with covid constraints - freshmen would be mixed with JV & Varsity - coaches salaries would be a reduction and reduction in athletic transportation costs - conservative approach to identify a savings

Member Van der Kloot - wondering if certain sports will even be able to be played? Maybe move some funds to other sports, yet I know we don't have enough information yet

Member Graham - Will we receive a piece of paper with a narrative at some point? I can't even feel like that I can ask any questions

Ms. Patterson - Our binder process is in place - there is a delineation of each program listed along with supplemental information, etc. We were minimizing staffing impacts up until just

prior to the meeting - The binders will be printed tomorrow and I will have them for you this weekend.

Member Graham - For example, we weren't aware about freshmen sports until right now. We need to see the cuts clearly outlined. No surprises. We need to know what is in, and what is out of budget. Investments clearly made by CARES funding are not at the expense of teachers, correct?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes

Member Graham - It needs to be stated that the CARES money cannot be used for salaries and can only be utilized for very specific uses.

Member Kreatz - I know you said we'd get our budget books this weekend. Will the union union presidents get a budget book prior to Monday's meeting as well?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We planned to get it to the school committee this weekend and then I'll reach out to the unions to pick up Monday.

Member Kreatz - Thank you - Thank you for narrative Ms. Graham - So will we have an outline at the beginning of the budget book, with highlights and/or reductions, as we have had in the past?

Ms. Patterson - I'm working on the budget binder - \$3.5 M - are the reductions that I just clarified in the slide deck. During the public hearing budget review, we will compare FY 20 to FY 21.

Member Van der Kloot -I feel like the income - \$99, 586,000 - is very conservative. Does it include the tuitions for the Vocational School and the Curtis Tufts?

Ms. Patterson - those will be repurposed for those programs due to budget cuts

Member Van der Kloot - It's very, very conservative - I almost feel we are cutting too much right now. I need to keep that in mind.

Member Ruseau - I have to say we are not an overloaded district. It is hard to get information sometimes as there isn't anyone available to do it. The budget historically goes up only \$2M each year. Our teachers aren't paid enough. Even during a good economy, we couldn't discuss raising teacher salaries. I don't want to call it a cut. Level funding is a dramatic cut.

Member Kreatz - This was a very difficult budget. It has never happened before. Member McLaughlin and myself showed our support to the teachers association yesterday. A lot of the speakers said there just is not enough money to provide a proper education. Some of the city councillors said they'd support rainy day funds to go to schools. It is a dire situation. Very upsetting. I've received a number of emails to support additional funding. I realize we are waiting for money from the state and federal government. No one can tell us now. So it's a waiting game.

Member McLaughlin - This is also a fluid situation. It has resulted in a lot of sleepless nights from all different parties. Governor Baker announced today some additional funding assistance. Like the DLP, people should understand things are changing frequently. Thank you Member Kreatz for attending the MTA rally. I know we all have even more appreciation for teachers, after having to homeschool these past few months. A lot of compassion for teachers was on display yesterday

Member Kreatz - I want to thank the administrative team, Ms. Nunley, Mr. Rosetti and Ms. Patterson. I appreciate that every time I reached out to the Superintendent, she always responded. Incredible efforts by all. I appreciate everyone. It has been a long difficult process. You have done a great job. I hope we can find some funding in the future

Mayor - Well there is some good news to report. Representative Donato informed me today that he put through \$454,000 for additional PPE and technology. We are awaiting the federal stimulus. It is extremely hard for us. We are hoping for help this summer for our schools

Mayor - The MHS Vision Committee resolution from Member Van der Kloot

Member Van der Kloot - This committee came out of discussions held in the Building & Grounds Subcommittee, and was designed to consider the future of the Medford High School building. However, I feel it should be disbanded so that a new racially diverse advisory committee can be established per school committee guidelines, by December 1, 2020.

Member McLaughlin - I propose a friendly amendment, that this Vision Committee be reflective of the MHS community.

Mayor - Member Van der Kloot motion is on the floor for a vote, seconded by Member by Member McLaughlin

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - paper passes

Member McLaughlin - Point of information - I wanted to publicly thank the Mayor for your letter yesterday.

Mayor - I agree with this motion. We plan to host our next roundtable after July 4th with the goal of finding ways to increase diversity on our boards and commissions, in city hall and in our schools.

Member McLaughlin - When communications go out, I would suggest that the wording be vetted for potentially offensive language. I think it is important to address it with people who have knowledge on this matter.

Mayor - do we have a motion to enter the executive session?

Member Ruseau - I know this is out of order, but I do have an email regarding the budget

Member Van der Kloot - We need to hear the email question

Member McLaughlin - I make a motion to revert back to finances, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Member Ruseau - *Email from Jessica Szubart, from 79 Governors Ave*

Comments: I am relatively new to municipal budget review and considerations, but like many people here, have plenty of experience doing this in the private sector for my job. I've always seen budgets as an excel representation of priorities. What are we investing in, what do we believe in, what is working, what needs help? When I look at the Medford municipal budget as a whole, our investment, or lack thereof, in our schools stands out compared to our neighbors. Malden, Arlington and Woburn all spend over 40% of their municipal budget to schools. We invest 33%. There are many investments in city budgets that tend to be controversial, but I rarely hear cries from people who think that we should invest less money in educating our children. What you will hear is pushback on where that money should come from. With that in mind, I urge the Mayor to compare how we spend our City's money compared to our neighbors. I don't believe that this is a matter of having to spend more money as a city, I believe that as a city, we can spend the money that we have in a better way. I realize that COVID-19 has made everything harder, but this isn't a time to be discussing cuts, it's a time to be discussing re-evaluating priorities. Money that we cut or spend today doesn't have an impact for a few years, it has an

impact on a generation of children. I ask you to act accordingly. I thank the Committee for its time and consideration.

Member Graham -Are we going to review the memo that will accompany the budget to the Council?

Member Graham reads memo: In an effort to ensure transparency to your honorable body and the public, the Medford School Committee in collaboration with Superintendent Edouard-Vincent is providing this memo to serve as an overarching narrative on the school budget.

Funding Sources The Medford School Committee primarily receives funding from the City of Medford. The Medford School Committee cannot approve a budget that is in excess of the appropriation provided by the City of Medford, as directed by the Mayor and approved by the City Council.

In addition to this funding, the School Committee has responsibility for a number of revolving accounts (e.g., after school tuition, pool and rink fees and expenses, and school lunch revenue and expenses). Further, the School Committee receives some direct funding from State and Federal Grants. The Medford School Committee can and does rely on these funding sources to offset needed expenditures that are in excess of the city appropriation.

For the FY20 budget we relied on \$1.8 million in revenue from various revolving accounts and State and Federal Grant funding to supplement the city appropriation of \$61,250,000.

Beginning in FY21, the Student Opportunity Act is slated to provide additional aid to cities and towns to level the playing field and close the vast achievement gap seen in education across the state. In FY21, year 1 of the phase-in, Medford was slated to receive only \$138,000 in additional aid. It is unclear whether this funding will be delayed due to state budget issues.

Budget Process As in years past, the school budget process began in February. Departments presented their budgets to the School Committee. In their presentation, they highlighted a summary of accomplishments of the past year, and requests for the upcoming year. The 'Budget Build' contains department narratives and a financial view of past years, current year expenses, and projected new expenses. In a typical year the 'Budget Build' shows an increase for the upcoming year in the neighborhood of 2.5%-5%. In addition to the information included in the 'Budget Build', this year the School Committee requested that the following question be answered as well. This question was unanimously passed by the School Committee and was part of the budget process from the beginning.

“Identify 3-5 items, initiatives, personnel, or costs that, if prioritized during the budget process, would positively impact student achievement that are in addition to the requested budget presented. List a brief description and estimated cost for each. Think big, or small. Nothing is off the table in this section.”

Despite the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic the departments worked through this process to ensure an adequate baseline of information before COVID-19 related cuts were introduced. The requests made by departments in answer to the question above currently tally at more than \$9.2 million. It is important to note that this list is surely incomplete, and will likely change annually as conditions, education, and student needs evolve. Of that amount, \$4.977 million are attributable to recurring items that are needed in future budgets once funded. ***The full list of items identified during this year’s budget process is available at the end of this report (Appendix A).*** The School Committee offers this categorization/prioritization of costs:

Funded These items were prioritized in the draft budget that will be subject of a public hearing on 6/29/2020 \$93,000.00. Funded by CARES Act
Medford Public Schools used its CARES Act funding (description below) to fund these needs \$679,228.28

Critical FY21 These items are essential, especially in light of our COVID-19 realities for school year 2020-2021 \$4,563,998.00

Necessary These items are essential, but given the COVID-19 realities for school year 2020-2021, they can be deferred \$1,913,665.00

Future These items will become essential and even required in the next 2-3 years as student populations in the Vocational School and other special areas grow \$300,000.00

Medium These items include machines/equipment desired by the vocational school, full time librarians at every school, and a new building key card system. Workarounds exist until they can be prioritized. \$1,516,100.00

Discretionary These items include display cases, physical fitness equipment to expand our offering, and teacher stipends for after school/enrichment activities \$222,691.65 2

Our budget process is concluded by a state mandated budget hearing, scheduled for 6/29/2020 and then a vote by the School Committee.

FY21 Outlook The School Committee has been directed to assume a level-funded budget with an appropriation of \$61,250,000 from the City of Medford. We estimate that contractual costs will increase \$2.5 million from FY20 to FY21 and that we will not be able to rely on revolving accounts to the large degree we have in past years. We estimate that we will see a \$1 million reduction in revolving funds available. So this presents a \$3.5 million gap (or cut) to see level service across the district. The Superintendent has created a path to achieve this cut while attempting to keep the impact as far away from the classroom as is possible. She has looked carefully at reductions across the administrative functions and will be asking staff to assume additional responsibilities where headcount reductions have been made.

In order to close this gap, we have planned for the following:

1. Offered a small early retirement incentive to all unions. Not all unions elected to participate and participation was limited.
2. eliminated the following positions:
 - a. 12 classroom positions due to limited enrollment b. 9 Tier 2 interventionists ¹ c. 2 elementary level math coaches ² d. 3 Italian teachers at the elementary school level (partially grant funded in FY20, no grant funding available going forward) e. 4 secretarial positions f. 1 paraprofessional position g. Elimination of the Educational Team Leader position for Early Education Referrals
3. Restructured the following leadership positions:
 - a. Elimination of the Paraprofessional Coordinator Role b. Elimination of an Assistant Principal at Medford High School c. Elimination of the Fine Arts Director Position (duties assumed by the Director of Curriculum & Instruction) d. Combining the Guidance Director and the Supervisor of Clinical/Behavioral into a Director of Counseling Services
4. Reduced non-personnel budget through reductions, supplies and contracted services.

Teachers in these eliminated positions who have professional status will be placed in a homeroom ³ setting.

This reassignment work is in process ² Teachers in these eliminated positions who have professional status will be placed in a homeroom ³ setting. This reassignment work is in process

3

The below chart provides a summary of the cuts. The chart describes the reduction source first by identifying what portion of the FY20 operating budget the source represents, then lays out the cost savings in dollars, and finally attributes each source to a percentage of the \$3.5M reduction

Retirements (with replacements) \$330,000 10%

Supply and non-staff \$800,000 22%

	Positions
Restructuring Leadership	50,000 27%

Reducing Positions \$1,420,000 41%

Estimated Total \$3,500,000 100%

We understand the crisis that our city budget faces. We understand that without a picture of state and federal aid there may be additional cuts presented for the City of Medford to address. We have worked hard to keep these cuts as far away from the classroom as possible and we have not asked our staff to forgo contractually obligated increases in the coming year. But we would be remiss if we did not highlight the deep issues this current budget year creates for our district. It is our shared agreement that we cannot cut deeper without further impacting students and teachers. The cuts are already too deep and impact too many teachers and students.

Priorities for FY21 We don't believe that a \$3.5 million cut is in the best interests of Medford's teachers and students. Beyond the budget that we will consider on 6/29/2020, we are highlighting the following critical needs should grants, stimulus, or other funding avenues create an additional appropriation for our schools. We humbly ask the City Council to collaborate with us if it becomes possible to reverse budget cuts that would allow for some or all of the following. The list below is preliminary, and not exclusive, but serves to illustrate what the district needs next year. ***The Superintendent will prioritize additional monetary allocation to best serve the needs of our 4200 students.***

Technology All Full model laptops for 418 teachers \$418,000.00

Elementary Elementary School CORE 5 - Lexia \$19,980.00

English Language Arts Elementary School CORE 5 - Lexia \$13,900.00

English Language Arts Middle School NewsELA and Think Central \$50,000.00

Roberts Elementary School .6 FTE adjustment counselor \$37,800.00

Health Services Middle School Andrews Nurse \$65,000.00

Special Education Elementary School 2 paraprofessionals for Connections at Roberts \$50,000.00

Finance All 2 Accounting Specialists \$160,000.00

Districtwide All Director of Communication and Family Engagement \$120,000.00

Library/Media/ Tech All Cybersecurity training/PD \$10,000.00

Library/Media/ Tech All 4.5 tech support staff \$239,850.00

Library/Media/ Tech All Diversity holdings for our library collection \$3,000.00

Technology All 340 additional WAPs \$340,000.00

Elementary School Handwriting materials and training - Zaner Blosser \$5,968.00

Phys Ed/Health All Adaptive PE Teacher \$65,000.00

Phys Ed/Health Middle School Health Teacher \$65,000.00

Social Studies Middle School NewsELA and Civics Project \$10,000.00

Brooks Elementary School Special Ed Teacher \$63,000.00

Columbus Elementary School .5 FTE adjustment counselor \$31,500.00

McGlynn Elementary Elementary School .5 FTE adjustment counselor \$31,500.00

McGlynn Middle McGlynn Additional Language Based Program Teacher \$63,000.00

Special Education High School Special Ed Teacher \$60,000.00

Special Education Elementary/Preschool Speech Language Pathologist \$60,000.00

Special Education Elementary School Orton-Gillingham Training (summer) \$170,000.00

Special Education All Autism Specialist \$80,000.00 5

Vocational School Voke Ventilation Upgrades \$25,000.00

Buildings and Grounds Elementary New Scrubber for Columbus \$3,500.00

Special Education Elementary School Additional ASD Teacher for Roberts \$60,000.00

Elementary Elementary School 4 reading specialists \$260,000.00

ELA High School 2 Reading specialists \$150,000.00

ELA Elementary School 2 Instructional Leaders - Literacy \$204,000.00

Elementary Elementary School 2 Instructional Leaders - Literacy \$204,000.00

Mathematics Middle School 2 Instructional Leaders - Math \$204,000.00

Mathematics Elementary School 4 Instructional Leaders - Math \$408,000.00

Andrews Andrews PT math teacher for TLP students \$30,000.00

Andrews Andrews Additional Language Based Program Teacher \$63,000.00

All ALL 9 Tier 2 interventionists \$720,000.00

Critical Needs for FY21 Total: \$4,563,998.00

Fall 2020 Return to School As a district we await state guidance on the reopening of schools in the fall. We are aware that, until a vaccine is available, we may see additional school closures and distance learning requirements. Experts estimate that school will cost \$1 million - \$1.5 million more to operate during the next school year due to the COVID-19 pandemic than it did in FY20. The current budget does not address this reality.

Medford Public Schools have received ESSER Funds from the federal CARES Act in the amount of \$600,639.35. We have submitted a grant proposal to access the funds which has been accepted for July 1. By and large, the funding will be used to infuse our district with the Chromebooks and internet access devices necessary to be prepared for additional distance learning. At present we have only 1/2 of the devices needed to meet a 1 Chromebook per student goal. This infusion of over 1900 devices will help mitigate the device deficiency. In addition, funds have been allocated for the following:

- Professional development including Responsive Classroom, Zones of Regulation, and virtual teaching, trauma, and mindfulness
- Cleaning and sanitation supplies

- Lexia rapid screening tool for K-2 students
- 50 internet hot-spots
- Subscriptions to BrainPop, TeachTown, Listenwise, and other online materials

In the event that distance learning is necessary in the upcoming school year, we will plan to use our learning from these past months and determine how to improve our plans. Distance learning is a radical shift in education nationally, and requires a substantially different set of tools than we currently use. We are working to provide mandatory professional development to teachers, but professional development alone cannot ensure a seamless transition out of the classroom. As a district we contend with significant equity issues that aren't resolved by providing Chromebooks alone. Our most vulnerable populations will be most severely impacted throughout any school closure and for years to come. Our actions and ability to fund the district through distance learning, and to mitigate the impact on our students once school returns to normal, will have a defining impact on the 4200 students currently enrolled in Medford Public Schools. This is a responsibility we take seriously and the city's budget crisis significantly limits our ability to mitigate these issues.

Strategic Outlook As we navigate out of the budget crisis created by COVID-19 in the coming budget cycles, we believe that the list referenced above provides a meaningful look at the items we need to improve student outcomes for all students in Medford. As we noted, there are items we can call discretionary, but the list of necessities and medium priorities should be viewed as needs and not wants. We know that this is the first time in recent memory that the School Committee has collected information such as this and that it is not reasonable to expect this overnight, but we look forward to working with you to determine when and how we can achieve these spending increases as a continued investment in our students and schools. We stand ready to help lobby our state and federal delegation, and to educate the residents of Medford on the constraints that our current revenue sources place on us.

To be clear, we currently make do without these items, but we believe that the children of Medford deserve a school system resourced to do more than make do without the specific items their educators believe will positively impact their achievement. There are so many strengths across our district, our teaching staff among them. Proper resourcing of our talented administrators and teachers is needed to lift our district to where we want to be and to achieve our mission.

As we look to the fall, a strong return to school is our top priority, but our team is united in the goals to resume the strategic planning work begun by the Superintendent and to dissolve and restart the Medford High School Vision Committee. Medford's children, whom we have the privilege to educate for 13 short years, deserve our on-going efforts to positively impact their learning. We expect this list of needs will change as those efforts get underway and it is our hope that we will continue to drive this kind of conversation across our departments on an annual basis. The need for MPS to do more, make

progress, and improve outcomes for all students is not new, and it will never be complete. It is our mission and our vision. You have our commitment that we will continue to make progress and work in partnership with your honorable body. We thank you for your past commitment to our schools and for your partnership in support of the future. We are One Medford.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Lexia Core 5 is high on the list, Rosella, and Ringcentral. Adjustment Counselors to provide additional supports to students with greatest needs

Member McLaughlin - there are some items I would have liked to see on this list, such as a grant writer department, top of my list - SEPAC has consistently requested an inclusion coordinator - these are things that are needed - if this is a working document, I would recommend a grant writer to help support these costs and an inclusion coordinator - far too many sub separate classrooms

Member Kreatz - Thank you Member Graham - We did try to have a subcommittee meeting to design this memo, but there was no time

Member Van der Kloot - This is the first time the members have seen this document. Thanks to the Superintendent's team who worked on it. Some of the wants have been absorbed by another administrator. I would like to congratulate Mr. Szykniej on his retirement. There were new recommendations that came out today that we need to look at. I'd like to recraft the sentiment

Member McLaughlin - what is the process with this document? Are we wordsmithing it?- Is there an opportunity for public participation tonight or Monday for additions to this document?

Mayor - Where can additional requests be sent too?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, they can be sent to me.

Member McLaughlin - it was intending to be a subcommittee meeting so

Mayor - we can't collaborate - but we can send our suggestions to the Superintendent and we can vote Yay or Nay on Monday

Member Ruseau - we can't approve a budget without this document

Member McLaughlin - having some time would be good -

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I will look at your feedback all weekend and I'll make the revisions

Mayor - I just got the document so I'd love to digest it too - but a budget mtg isn't ideal either

Member Ruseau - We still have to look at the budget - plus this letter - a lot to do over the weekend - I'm fine waiting until Monday - the fact that it's June 29th, isn't going to rush me to vote

Member Kreatz - I'm fine waiting until Monday and sending edits to Superintendent over weekend

Member Van der Kloot - I agree - Send additions or revisions to Superintendent

Member McLaughlin - depth of the work involved in this document - it's important - I hope this isn't the only time this narrative is included - very important to do this - Other districts fund their schools at 40% vs. Medford who funds it at 32% - Education underfunded in Medford for a long, long time - so the budget reflects our values

Member Graham - the other option would be to take a recess tonight and independently review it - bring this up so public can comment as well - and then discuss changes that are proposed -

Member Van der Kloot - I think we need to process it - I need a good chance to read it - I don't think our budget meeting should begin with this - we should focus on the budget first on Monday

Member Ruseau - I don't care when it's brought up, but I'm not voting on the budget without this document included - we need more - so councillors can't say that we haven't asked

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I will gather the information over weekend - Sunday I could send to you - you'd have the time to look at it prior to Monday's meeting as it doesn't begin until 4 PM. Due to the lack of time, we couldn't schedule an additional subcommittee meeting - It's not a daunting task for me, something I can handle & doable for Monday's meeting

Member Graham - I'm fine to move it to Monday, but it should come first - I won't vote on a budget without it

Member Kreatz - I think we should discuss it first and then vote on it and go to budget

Mayor -Okay any additions and/or edits should be sent to the Superintendent by Sunday evening. Motion to approve by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Graham

Member Van der Kloot - I wanted to be clear to my colleagues that we'd vote budget and then discuss it -

Member McLaughlin - I want to be clear - I concur - don't want to vote budget until this document is approved

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - paper passes

Mayor - motion to go into executive session by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Motion passes - 6:16 PM

Mayor - thank you for your patience - we still have 73 people on this call - we do not have anything to report out - motion to adjourn?

Motion to adjourn by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member/Graham

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Motion passes

Meeting adjourned - 8:06 PM